

► Introduction

In August 2023, the ILO published the first global employment estimates of potential occupational exposure to generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) (Gmyrek et al., 2023). This research was prompted by concerns – that have featured prominently in the media – of the potential for the technology to replace large shares of knowledge work.

Since the release of the 2023 estimates, there have been further technological advances in GenAI, including the introduction of Large Language Models (LLMs) with expanded capabilities in image recognition and audio and video production. Moreover, many new GenAI applications have been developed as a result of the possibility of linking GenAI models with Application Programming Interface (API) tools. Indeed, GenAI has been likened to a general-purpose technology, meaning that it may continue generating new applications and innovations across various sectors, driving long-term economic and societal transformations.

Despite this rapidly developing landscape, it is important for policy makers to develop deeper understanding of how technological advances might impact existing jobs. To address this need, the Research department of the ILO has partnered with NASK, the National Research Institute of the Ministry of Digital Affairs in Poland, to develop a more precise assessment of potential effects of GenAI on employment across countries.

This study builds on the method developed by the ILO (Gmyrek, Berg and Bescond, 2023 - GBB hereafter), which used task descriptions from the 4-digit International Standard Classification of Occupations (ISCO-08) and the GPT-4 model to estimate task-level and occupational scores of exposure to GenAI technology and then derives global employment estimates based on official ILO labour force data. But the study includes several key refinements.

The first step in our analysis is based on Poland's national 6-digit classification of occupations that includes nearly 30,000 tasks. This expands tenfold the number of tasks given in the ISCO-08 structure and enables a fine-grained assessment of tasks' automation potential, based on a more up-to-date set of occupations and tasks than those captured in the ISCO-08 system. As Poland's 6-digit classification is aligned with the 4-digit ISCO-08, the occupational scores can be compiled at the 4-digit level allowing a straightforward comparison and updating of the 2023 estimates of the ILO (GBB). In addition, the study improves the methodological framework of GBB, by drawing on the combined strengths of human and AI abilities, with an additional layer of expert verification.

Specifically, we surveyed 1,640 people currently employed in Poland in each ISCO-08 1-digit group to rank the automation potential of a representative sample of tasks that pertain to their occupational group. As the second step, we asked a mix of national and international experts to conduct a detailed review of a large sample of tasks previously assessed in the survey to validate or adjust the level of automation scores through an iterative process. Since we maintain the hierarchical link to ISCO-08 and focus on technological feasibility rather than specific country context, by combining opinions of local and international experts, we create a system that enables more precise predictions of the potential of automation of individual occupational tasks with GenAI technology, including at the international level. To achieve that, we input the human scores into an AI model, to generate scores reflecting human judgement for nearly 30,000 individual tasks pertaining to 2,500 occupations at 6-digit level in Poland. We then use the same AI predictor to re-generate scores for the tasks in ISCO-08, previously provided by GBB (2023), thereby adjusting the 2023 index of the ILO, which now benefits from both the input of people

► Conclusion

In this paper, we have presented the methodology used to develop a new global index of occupational exposure to GenAI, as well as new estimates of the global effects on employment. We build on the approach developed by the ILO in 2023, but with several notable refinements. First, by beginning our analysis with the Polish 6-digit occupational structure, we expand by ten-fold the amount of detailed task information available for the analysis of task automation. In addition, using a representative sample from the 29,753 tasks in the Polish occupational classification system and a survey of 1,640 people in Poland, we captured the opinions of each 1-digit ISCO-08 group on the potential for task automation in the job categories in which they are currently employed (52,558 data points). We then compared this input with an expert survey and conducted subsequent rounds of revisions among a smaller international expert group for the tasks with the highest degree of disagreement. Based on this process, we built a repository of knowledge with adjusted task scores that goes beyond Poland's national specificities and reflects a broader consensus on the task automation potential of current GenAI tools.

We subsequently used this repository to develop an AI assistant that could predict scores for these tasks based on this additional information as well as the technical documentation of ISCO-08. These scores update the original set of scores produced by the ILO in 2023 (Gmyrek et al., 2023). The use of a verified "knowledge base" presents an important methodological improvement, which greatly enhances stability of our predictions across independent LLMs (see Section 6), and which can be used to produce similar score predictions for other occupational classification systems that contain job-specific tasks. In addition, we make all task-level scores publicly available, which also makes it possible for researchers to organize the occupational exposure in different ways than our proposed framework of exposure gradients.

The new global index presented in this paper is generic, due to the nature of ISCO-08 and the structure of tasks associated with occupations in this framework. Its definite strength – similar to ISCO-08 – is that it provides a common global denominator and a direct link to national labour forces surveys held in the ILO harmonized micro data repository, which relies on the same classification of occupational structures. Even though all countries do not use ISCO-08, mappings of the national systems to this common international standard are available. This eliminates the need for crosswalks from other national systems (e.g. O*NET), which involves tenuous assumptions about the similarity of detailed occupations in the technologically advanced context of the USA to other countries, especially non-HICs. The simple and comparable character of our ISCO-08 based index enables direct production of global, regional and income-based employment estimates, based on the same statistical modelling techniques that are used by the ILO for other global figures (see Section 11).

Our 2025 scores are presented in a revised occupational classification system, adopting a framework of four progressively increasing exposure gradients, that better highlights the importance of potential AI exposure and task variability for determining possible outcomes. We produced a new set of global estimates of GenAI exposure based on this revised classification.

The new index maintains many of the headline findings of the 2023 methodology. Clerical occupations continue to have the highest exposure levels, albeit with some important downward revisions to individual tasks scores. Such occupations include data entry clerks, typists, accounting, bookkeeping clerks and administrative secretaries. Additionally, some occupations – such as financial analysts, and web and multimedia developers (gradient 4), as well as bank tellers, translators, applications programmers, investment advisers (gradient 3) – have increased their